

Part III — Jñāna-kāṇḍa

తృతీయః షడ్కః : తృతీయ పట్కము

Knowledge & Synthesis — Chapters 13 to 18 of the Bhagavad Gītā

Chapters 13–18 answer the third great question: *"What is reality, and how do all these paths fit together?"*

This final section is the Gītā's **metaphysical synthesis**. It analyzes the relationship between consciousness and matter (Ch 13), the three universal forces (Ch 14), the inverted cosmic tree (Ch 15), the two opposing natures within every human (Ch 16), the role of faith (Ch 17), and finally — in the longest and most comprehensive chapter (Ch 18) — it ties **every thread of the entire Gītā** together in a single grand finale, ending with the verse Mahatma Gandhi called **the supreme verse of the Gītā**: *"Surrender unto Me alone. I shall liberate you from all sins. Do not grieve."*

The six yogas of Part III — at a glance

CH	NAME (YOGA)	ESSENTIAL TAKE-AWAY
13	Kṣetra-Ksetrajña Yoga క్షేత్రక్షేత్రజ్ఞవిభాగయోగః క్షేత్రక్షేత్రజ్ఞవిభాగయోగము "The Field & the Knower of the Field"	The body (and even mind, intellect, ego) is the "field" (kṣetra) ; pure awareness is the "Knower of the Field" (ksetrajña) . You are not what you have or do — you are the witness . The most direct teaching on non-dual awareness in the Gītā.
14	Guṇa-Traya Yoga గుణత్రయవిభాగయోగః గుణత్రయవిభాగయోగము "The Three Guṇas"	All of nature is woven from three strands: sattva (purity, light), rajas (activity, passion), tamas (inertia, dullness). They bind the soul like ropes. Transcend them — guṇātīta — and you are free .
15	Puruṣottama Yoga పురుషోత్తమయోగః పురుషోత్తమయోగము "The Supreme Person"	Reality is like an inverted aśvattha tree with roots above (the Divine) and branches below (the world). Cut the root of attachment with the axe of detachment. The Lord is the Puruṣottama — the Supreme Person, beyond both the perishable and the imperishable.
16	Daivāsura-Sampad Yoga దైవాసురసంపద్విభాగయోగః దైవాసురసంపద్విభాగయోగము "Divine & Demonic Natures"	Two tendencies in every human: divine (fearlessness, truth, compassion, humility) leading to liberation, and demonic (arrogance, lust, anger, greed) leading to bondage. Cultivate the divine; uproot the demonic . Scripture is your guide.
17	Śraddhā-Traya Yoga శ్రద్ధాత్రయవిభాగయోగః శ్రద్ధాత్రయవిభాగయోగము "Three Kinds of Faith"	Your faith (śraddhā) shapes you — and faith has three textures (sāttvika, rājasika, tāmasika) reflected in your food, sacrifices, charity, and austerity. <i>"You are what you believe in."</i> The sacred syllable Om Tat Sat sanctifies all action.
18	Mokṣa-Sannyāsa Yoga మోక్షసన్యాసయోగః మోక్షసన్యాసయోగము "Liberation through Renunciation"	The Gītā's grand finale . True renunciation is not abandoning action — it is abandoning attachment to fruits. Do your own duty (svadharma) imperfectly rather than another's perfectly. The closing call : <i>"sarva-dharmān parityajya mām ekaṁ śaraṇaṁ vraja"</i> (18.66) — "Abandon all dharmas; take refuge in Me alone. I shall liberate you. Do not grieve."

The arc of Part III · Consciousness vs. matter (Ch 13) → Transcending nature's three forces (Ch 14) → The Supreme Person (Ch 15) → Divine vs. demonic in us (Ch 16) → The faith that shapes us (Ch 17) → Surrender & liberation (Ch 18).

□ The essential verses of Part III

BG 13.2 Ch 13 · The most direct teaching on the Witness Self

क्षेत्रज्ञं चापि मां विद्धि सर्वक्षेत्रेषु भारत ।

क्षेत्रक्षेत्रज्ञयोर्ज्ञानं यत्तज्ज्ञानं मतं मम ॥ १३.२ ॥

*kṣetrajñam cāpi mām viddhi sarva-kṣetreṣu bhārata |
kṣetra-kṣetrajñayor jñānam yat taj jñānam matam mama | |*

"Know Me as the Knower of the Field in all fields, O Bhārata.
Knowledge of the Field and the Knower of the Field — that is true Knowledge, in My view."

BG 14.26 Ch 14 · Bhakti as the path beyond the three guṇas

मां च योऽव्यभिचारेण भक्तियोगेन सेवते ।

स गुणान्समतीत्यैतान्ब्रह्मभूयाय कल्पते ॥ १४.२६ ॥

*mām ca yo 'vyabhicāreṇa bhakti-yogena sevate |
sa guṇān samatītyaitān brahma-bhūyāya kalpate | |*

"One who serves Me with unwavering bhakti-yoga
transcends these three guṇas
and becomes fit for absorption into Brahman."

BG 15.7 Ch 15 · The soul is My eternal fragment

ममैवांशो जीवलोके जीवभूतः सनातनः ।

मनःषष्ठानीन्द्रियाणि प्रकृतिस्थानि कर्षति ॥ १५.७ ॥

*mamaivāṁśo jīva-loke jīva-bhūtaḥ sanātanaḥ |
manaḥ-ṣaṣṭhānīndriyāṇi prakṛti-sthāni karṣati | |*

"An eternal fragment of My own self,
having become the individual soul in this world of life,
draws to itself the six senses (including the mind), which abide in nature."

BG 18.66 □ The supreme verse of the Gītā (charama-śloka)

सर्वधर्मान्परित्यज्य मामेकं शरणं ब्रज ।

अहं त्वा सर्वपापेभ्यो मोक्षयिष्यामि मा शुचः ॥ १८.६६ ॥

సర్వధర్మాన్పరিত్యజ్య మమేకం శరణం బ్రజ ।

అహం త్వా సర్వపాపేభ్యో మోక్షయిష్యామి మా శుచః ॥ ౧౮.౬౬ ॥

*sarva-dharmān parityajya mām ekaṁ śaraṇam vraja |
ahaṁ tvām sarva-pāpebhyo mokṣayiṣyāmi mā śucaḥ | |*

"Abandoning all dharmas, take refuge in Me alone.
I shall liberate you from all sins.
Do not grieve."
The final call of the Gītā. Many traditions consider this the single most important verse.

यत्र योगेश्वरः कृष्णो यत्र पार्थो धनुर्धरः ।

yatra yogeśvaraḥ kṛṣṇo yatra pāṛtho dhanur-dharaḥ |

**"Wherever there is Kṛṣṇa, the Lord of Yoga,
and wherever there is Pārtha, the wielder of the bow —
there will be prosperity, victory, well-being, and firm righteousness.
This is my conviction."**

1. kṣetrajñam cāpi mām viddhi (13.2) — *The Knower in every field is the Divine.*

2. *mamaivāṁśo jīva-loke* (15.7) — *The soul is an eternal fragment of the Divine.*

3. *sarva-dharmān parityajya mām ekaṁ śaraṇaṁ vraja* (18.66) — Surrender unto Me alone. I shall liberate you.